

Life in thin air

Walk up a mountain and you'll find that the habitat begins to change the higher you go. It also gets harder to breathe.

Mountain zones

A temperate mountain (a mountain in a cool part of the world) has distinct zones, each with its own wildlife.

A rare sight

There are thought to be fewer than 380 wild mountain gorillas. Although they look fearsome, gorillas are peaceful vegetarians.

Mountain gorilla



Alpine zone

In cool parts of the world, mountain peaks have a permanent coating of snow. Nothing grows at this height.

Alpine meadows

In the spring, as the snow begins to melt, lush meadows come alive with flowers. This zone is above the treeline.

Conifer trees

Conifers are adapted to surviving extreme cold. Even their shape protects against the weight of the snow.

Deciduous trees

Below the conifer trees, where the air gets a little warmer, grow the deciduous trees.

Time to wake up!

Mountain meadows are covered with snow in winter. Some animals, like marmots, survive this period by hibernating in burrows.

Alpine marmot



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